

VINAY NAIR

Lead Platform Engineer | SRE Architect | Cloud & AI Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Hands-on architect and SRE with 16 years of experience and full-spectrum depth: strong Python developer, expert in AWS, Terraform, and CI/CD, with genuine roots in enterprise Unix (Solaris, AIX) and petabyte-scale SAN/NAS. Built Shell's Enterprise Cloud Platform from the ground up, delivered €13M in verified cloud savings in a single year, and cut deployment cycles from one week to 20 minutes across 600+ AWS accounts — routinely delivering the output of a multi-engineer team. Currently building autonomous multi-agent AI systems in production with AWS Bedrock, AgentCore, and Strands SDK.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **€13M in verified cloud cost savings within 12 months** at Shell (CoCo programme) — FinOps automation, RI/Savings Plans, orphan cleanup, and executive dashboards across AWS and Azure
- **Cut deployment cycles from 1 week to 20 minutes** across 600+ AWS accounts — touchless change management, auto-tagging, Sonar, Checkov, and Copilot-assisted release notes
- **Built Shell's Enterprise Cloud Platform (ECP) from scratch** — one of the first engineers on the programme; grew it from managed services into a self-service platform serving 100+ engineering teams
- **Pioneered MLOps at Shell** — first engineer to deploy AWS SageMaker and Azure ML as centralised, shared platform services across the enterprise
- **Transformed a newly merged 25-person team** (5 dev, 20 ops) from a dysfunctional state into a high-performing SRE team using SRE principles and Scrum
- **Building autonomous multi-agent AI systems in production** with AWS Bedrock, AgentCore, and Strands SDK, including a production document-generation agent

CORE SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: AWS (Expert — Control Tower, EKS, SageMaker, Bedrock, Lambda, SSM, Step Functions, TGW, Config, GuardDuty) • Azure (AKS, Azure ML, AI Foundry, Azure DevOps) • GCP

AI / ML / Agents: AWS Bedrock • AgentCore • Strands SDK • SageMaker • Azure ML • Azure AI Foundry • Multi-agent orchestration

Kubernetes: EKS • AKS • ROSA • OpenShift • Helm • ArgoCD • Karpenter — CKA + CKAD certified

IaC / Automation: Terraform (Enterprise + Cloud) • StackSets • AVM • Ansible • Packer • AWS CDK • Python frameworks

CI/CD: GitHub Actions • Jenkins on Kubernetes • Concourse • Azure DevOps Pipelines • SonarQube • Checkov • GitHub Copilot

Observability: Prometheus • Grafana • Thanos • Dynatrace • ELK • CloudWatch • Datadog • DTrace

Security / FinOps: Security Hub • GuardDuty • Shield • WAF • Aqua CSPM • WIZ • HashiCorp Vault • CIS L2/3 • NIST • Well-Architected • RI/Savings Plans

Infrastructure: Linux • Unix (Solaris, AIX) • SAN/NAS (EMC CLARiiON, VMAX, NetApp, ZFS) • VMware • Networking • TSM

Languages: Python (primary — strong developer) • Bash • PowerShell • YAML • HCL • JavaScript • Golang (exposure)

Leadership: Product Owner • SAFe (PI planning, ART coordination) • Scrum • SRE coaching • HLD/LLD design • Staff SRE mentoring • Stakeholder engagement

Right to Work: Dutch national — unrestricted EU/NL work rights • UAE/Gulf visa-eligible • Open to relocation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Lead SRE, Architect & Mentor — AWS Enterprise Cloud Platform

Sep 2024 – Present

Shell — The Hague, Netherlands

- Rejoined Shell to lead a 12-person DevOps team running the AWS Enterprise Cloud Platform across 600+ business-critical accounts — while consistently authoring ~50% of the team's commits as top individual contributor
- Reduced deployment cycles from 1 week to 20 minutes — modernised CI/CD with touchless change management, automated release notes, auto-tagging, Sonar, Checkov, and Copilot PR analysis
- Overhauled EC2 agent provisioning and patching enterprise-wide — designed multi-Lambda SSM Automation for agent installation and domain join; enabled Dynamic Host Management Configuration (DHMC), retiring legacy compliance tooling
- Led StackSet-to-Terraform migration across 600+ AWS accounts (1,000+ resources per account); implemented AWS Backup with exception handling and flexible scheduling for enterprise-scale compliance
- Authored the *Shell AWS One Pager*, adopted Shell-wide as the definitive AWS onboarding and platform guide; primary mentor for Staff Lead SREs on HLD/LLD architecture and standards (CIS L2/3, NIST, Well-Architected)
- Led OpenShift and ROSA proof-of-concept to evaluate migration of 10,000+ VMs from VMware; building autonomous multi-agent AI systems with AWS Bedrock, AgentCore, and Strands SDK

Lead SRE & Product Owner — FinOps / Cloud Cost Optimisation (CoCo)

Aug 2023 – Sep 2024

Shell — The Hague, Netherlands

- Appointed to pioneer Shell's cloud cost optimisation programme within the Gravity/Burst core engineering team
- Delivered €13M in verified savings within 12 months across AWS and Azure — RI/Savings Plans, non-prod enforcement, orphaned AML/snapshot/disk cleanup, disk tier migrations, idle RDS and scheduled VM shutdowns, and Trusted Advisor automation
- Built gamified PowerBI dashboards visualising savings to drive competition and accountability across business units; worked as embedded SRE driving AWS and Azure initiatives in parallel

Product Owner & SRE Coach — AWS Platform Team

Aug 2022 – Jul 2023

Shell — Amsterdam, Netherlands

- Led a newly merged team of 25 engineers (5 dev, 20 ops) with no shared culture or tooling — resolved deep-rooted dev-vs-ops tension through SRE culture, Scrum ceremonies, shared ownership, and cross-skill upskilling programmes
- Built fully touchless ServiceNow workflows: account onboarding/update/decommission, IAM user creation, and image allowlisting
- Managed the platform behind 600+ business-critical AWS accounts; led AVM, StackSets, and AWS Control Tower implementation; Technical Review Board member with weekly AWS TAM engagement

Lead Site Reliability Engineer — Data Science & Observability

Sep 2021 – Jul 2022

Shell — Amsterdam, Netherlands

- Pioneered MLOps engineering at Shell — first to implement AWS SageMaker and Azure ML as centralised shared services
- Established centralised monitoring for 26 EKS/AKS clusters using Prometheus, Grafana, and Thanos
- Deployed Cloud Security Posture Management with Aqua and initiated the WIZ migration; implemented the Dremio data virtualisation platform with custom Python-built provisioning automation

Cloud DevOps Engineer

Sep 2020 – Sep 2021

Nationale-Nederlanden — The Hague, Netherlands

- Core member of the AWS Landing Zone team provisioning 500+ AWS accounts
- Overhauled the CI/CD system; designed Transit Gateway architecture with Direct Connect, egress firewall automation, DNS forwarders, and cross-account SSO
- Implemented the enterprise security framework — Config Rules, Security Hub, GuardDuty, Shield, WAF; redesigned Concourse pipelines and built an S3-based UI for SCP policy visualisation

Lead Site Reliability Engineer — Be.Agile Platform (AWS + Azure)

Jun 2019 – Aug 2020

Shell — Amsterdam, Netherlands

- Led the CI/CD team merging Shell's two developer platforms (SDU on AWS, Shell.AI on Azure) into the unified Be.Agile platform serving 400+ developers
- Architected cross-cloud CI/CD enabling deployments from AWS into Azure; integrated HashiCorp Vault and Terraform Enterprise into pipelines and expanded to additional EU regions
- Built a CI/CD clone app standardising deployments enterprise-wide, plus automated untagged-resource cleanup and non-prod VM sleep cycles

Site Reliability Engineer — Subsurface Data Universe (SDU)

May 2017 – May 2019

Shell — Bengaluru, India

- Core engineer on Shell's pioneering cloud-native programme serving 200+ petroleum data scientists on AWS
- Drove IaC from day one with Terraform and Packer — full provisioning from blank AWS account to Kubernetes; managed 600+ Lambdas, multi-region Kubernetes workloads, and CI/CD via Jenkins on Kubernetes

EARLIER CAREER

Duty Manager — Unix / Storage / Cloud Infrastructure

Sep 2014 – Apr 2017

Oracle India Pvt. Ltd — Bangalore, India

- Managed 900+ NAS filers and petabytes of enterprise data across Oracle's global storage estate; led ZFS replication automation, SAN performance optimisation, and DTrace-based NAS troubleshooting
- Acted as Shift Lead, coordinating cross-functional teams on incident response and change management

Consultant, Team Lead & Resource Manager — Unix / Storage / Infrastructure

Sep 2008 – Sep 2014

HCL Technologies — India

- Progressed from infrastructure consultant to Team Lead and Resource Manager within 4 years — managed 10+ engineers with responsibility for resource planning, allocation, and performance management
- Delivered storage management, backup/recovery, and SAN/NAS solutions for enterprise clients — Solaris, AIX, Linux; EMC CLARiiON, VMAX, NetApp, IBM TSM; Broadcom SAN switches and FC fabrics

CERTIFICATIONS, EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) — 2023 • Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD) — 2023 • Sun Certified Solaris Administrator 1 & 2
- Bachelor of Technology, Electrical, Electronics & Communications Engineering — University of Calicut, Kerala, India (2004–2008)
- English, Hindi, Malayalam, Tamil (excellent) • Dutch (conversational) • French (basic)